Traditional
POLS 207.401: State and Local Government
Fall 2022 – MWF (12:40 – 1:30) CLB 100

Mr. Adam Haney
Office Hours: via zoom or in person on MW 1:30-2:30 or by appointment @:

https://tamu.zoom.us/j/96187688846?pwd=b3pjVDBNNlUvczBoVUNvQUpTaXoxQT09

Credit Hours: 3
Office Phone: 740-4949
Office Location: CLB 103A
Email: Adam.Haney@tamu.edu

Required Text:
ISBN: 978-1071-80-8900
Lone Star Politics: Tradition and Transformation in Texas 7th ed.
Collier, Galats, Harrelson-Stevens.

ISBN: 978-0-525-56492-8
Where We Come From
Oscar Casares

Iclicker application – all students are required to use this application for attendance/participation. The link provided will allow you to download the application for free. No purchase necessary.

https://www.iclicker.com

Catalog Description: State and Local Government. Survey of state and local government and politics with special reference to the constitution and politics of Texas [sic]

Course Description:
The purpose of this course is to study the underlying ideas, principles, and participatory practices of constitutional government in the Texas. This course will introduce you to the historical, social, political, cultural, and global forces that formed the foundations for the Texas political system and continue to effect statewide political activity. Please note that you *will not* be taught *what* to think about political issues in this course. Rather, you will be provided with the knowledge base to determine *how* to think about political issues for *yourself*.

Prerequisites: NONE

Foundational Component Area and Core Objectives:

Government/Political Science

Format:

Each class session will involve online lectures typically in PowerPoint form and discussions about the assigned readings. You will regularly be asked to contribute and discuss your understanding about the assigned topics and answer questions about the readings.

Course Learning Outcomes:

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Demonstrate social and personal responsibility by mastery of concepts and terms relevant to the study of state and local government through artifact submission.
- Differentiate between fact and opinion. i.e. critical thinking, by identifying sources of information which are more likely to be biased through artifact submission.

Core Curriculum Objectives

Critical Thinking Skills- to include creative thinking, innovation, inquiry, and analysis, evaluation and synthesis of information
Communication Skills - to include effective development, interpretation and expression of ideas through written, oral and visual communication
Social Responsibility: to include intercultural competence, knowledge of civic responsibility, and the ability to engage effectively in regional, national, and global communities
Personal Responsibility: to include the ability to connect choices, actions and consequences to ethical decision-making

Grading Scale

Final grades will be based on a 100-point scale, using the following letter/number conversion.
A = 90-100 B = 80-89 C = 70-79 D = 60-69 F = Below 60

Grades:

Your grade in this course will be determined by the criteria listed below. Writing assignments will be announced during the course of the semester and the number of which may vary depending on the amount of class participation/discussion. The following scale will be used to determine your grade:

- Exam 1 = 20%
- Exam 2 = 20%
- Exam 3 = 20%
- Texas House Simulation papers (3x5%) = 15%
- Common Reader assignments = 15%
- Participation = 10%

NO LATE WORK WILL BE ACCEPTED UNLESS A RULE 7 EXCEPTION EXISTS.

The Tentative Readings and Course Schedule is provided so that you will be able to read ahead of the material to be covered that day so you will be prepared for class. **AND DISCUSSIONS!**

Tentative Readings and Course Schedule for POLS 207.401

Distrust

Week 1; Origins (Chapter 1)

Week 2; Constitutions (Chapter 2)

Week 3; Federalist Papers #10, #51 *Where We Come From* #1 1-77

Week 4; Legislature (Chapters 3)

September 16 – EXAM I (non-comprehensive)

Incompetence/Corruption

Week 5; Executive (Chapters 4-5) Simulation paper #1

Week 6; Judiciary (Chapters 6-7)

Week 7; Political Parties (Chapter 9) *Where We Come From* #2 78-165

Week 8; Organized Interests (Chapter 10)

Week 9; Campaigns & Elections (Chapter 8) Simulation paper #2

October 21 – EXAM II (non-comprehensive)

Apathy

Week 10; Texas House Simulation

Week 11; Local government (Chapter 11) *Where We Come From* #3 165-252

November 4 – NO CLASS!!

Week 12; Fiscal (Chapter 12)

Thanksgiving – November 21 NO CLASS!!

Week 13: Education, Immigration & Social Policies (Chapter 14) Simulation paper #3

Week 14; Energy, Environment, Transportation Policies (Chapter 13)

December 13 (8:00am – 10:00pm) - EXAM III (non-comprehensive)

Political Science 207.401

State and Local Government

Fall 2022

Mr. Adam Haney

Student Statement of Understanding:

I, _____, have read the syllabus and understand the guidelines and policies therein. Furthermore, I understand my obligation to adhere to these guidelines and policies in this class and failure to do so could result in my being dropped from the course or bring upon me some other corrective measure at the discretion of the professor. I understand that I am bound by the requirements listed therein.

Student's Signature: Student's UIN:

X_____ _____

Date: _____

*Fill in the above information and return via attachment to my email listed.

END OF REQUIRED PRINTING! EVERYTHING WHAT FOLLOWS IS ALREADY AVAILABLE IN THE STUDENT HANDBOOK.

University Policies

This section outlines the university level policies that must be included in each course syllabus. The TAMU Faculty Senate established the wording of these policies.

NOTE: *Faculty members should not change the written statements. A faculty member may add separate paragraphs if additional information is needed*.

Attendance Policy

The university views class attendance and participation as an individual student responsibility. Students are expected to attend class and to complete all assignments.

Please refer to Student Rule 7 in its entirety for information about excused absences, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.

Makeup Work Policy

Students will be excused from attending class on the day of a graded activity or when attendance contributes to a student's grade, for the reasons stated in Student Rule 7, or other reason deemed appropriate by the instructor.

Please refer to Student Rule 7 in its entirety for information about makeup work, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.

Absences related to Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 may necessitate a period of more than 30 days for make-up work, and the timeframe for make-up work should be agreed upon by the student and instructor" (Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.1).

"The instructor is under no obligation to provide an opportunity for the student to make up work missed because of an unexcused absence" (Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.2).

Students who request an excused absence are expected to uphold the Aggie Honor Code and Student Conduct Code. (See Student Rule 24.)

Academic Integrity Statement and Policy

"An Aggie does not lie, cheat or steal, or tolerate those who do."

"Texas A&M University students are responsible for authenticating all work submitted to an

instructor. If asked, students must be able to produce proof that the item submitted is indeed the work of that student. Students must keep appropriate records at all times. The inability to authenticate one's work, should the instructor request it, is sufficient grounds to initiate an academic dishonesty case" (Section 20.1.2.3, Student Rule 20).

You can learn more about the Honor Council Rules and Procedures as well as your rights and responsibilities at tamug.edu/HonorSystem.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Policy

Texas A&M University is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. If you experience barriers to your education due to a disability or think you may have a disability, please contact Disability Resources in the Student Services Building or at (409) 740-4587 or visit tamug.edu/counsel/Disabilities. Disabilities may include, but are not limited to attentional, learning, mental health, sensory, physical, or chronic health conditions. All students are encouraged to discuss their disability related needs with Disability Resources and their instructors as soon as possible.

Title IX and Statement on Limits to Confidentiality

Texas A&M University is committed to fostering a learning environment that is safe and productive for all. University policies and federal and state laws prohibit gender-based discrimination and sexual harassment, including sexual assault, sexual exploitation, domestic violence, dating violence, and stalking.

With the exception of some medical and mental health providers, all university employees (including full and part-time faculty, staff, paid graduate assistants, student workers, etc.) are Mandatory Reporters and must report to the Title IX Office if the employee experiences, observes, or becomes aware of an incident that meets the following conditions (see University Rule 08.01.01.M1):

- The incident is reasonably believed to be discrimination or harassment.
- The incident is alleged to have been committed by or against a person who, at the time of the incident, was (1) a student enrolled at the University or (2) an employee of the University.

Mandatory Reporters must file a report regardless of how the information comes to their attention – including but not limited to face-to-face conversations, a written class assignment or paper, class discussion, email, text, or social media post. Although Mandatory Reporters must file a report, in most instances, you will be able to control how the report is handled, including whether or not to pursue a formal investigation. The University's goal is to make sure you are aware of the range of options available to you and to ensure access to the resources you need.

Students wishing to discuss concerns in a confidential setting are encouraged to make an appointment with the Counseling Office in the Seibel Student Center, or call (409)740-4587. For additional information, visit tamug.edu/counsel.

Students can learn more about filing a report, accessing supportive resources, and navigating the Title IX investigation and resolution process on the Galveston Campus' Title IX webpage.

Statement on Mental Health and Wellness

Texas A&M University recognizes that mental health and wellness are critical factors that influence a student's academic success and overall wellbeing. Students are encouraged to engage in proper self-care by utilizing the resources and services available from the Counseling Center. Students who need someone to talk to can call (409) 740-4736 from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. weekdays or visit tamug.edu/counsel for more information. For 24-hour emergency assistance during nights and weekends, contact the TAMUG Police Dept at (409) 740-4545. 24-hour emergency help is also available through the National Suicide Prevention Hotline (800-273-8255) or at suicidepreventionlifeline.org.

COVID-19 Temporary Amendment to Minimum Syllabus Requirements

To help protect Aggieland and stop the spread of COVID-19, Texas A&M University urges students to be vaccinated and to wear masks in classrooms and all other academic facilities on campus, including labs. Doing so exemplifies the Aggie Core Values of respect, leadership, integrity, and selfless service by putting community concerns above individual preferences. COVID-19 vaccines and masking — regardless of vaccination status — have been shown to be safe and effective at reducing spread to others, infection, hospitalization, and death.

Personal Illness and Quarantine

Students required to quarantine must participate in courses and course-related activities remotely and **must not attend face-to-face course activities**. Students should notify their instructors of the quarantine requirement. Students under quarantine are expected to participate in courses and complete graded work unless they have symptoms that are too severe to participate in course activities.

Students experiencing personal injury or Illness that is too severe for the student to attend class qualify for an excused absence (See Student Rule 7, Section 7.2.2.) To receive an excused absence, students must comply with the documentation and notification guidelines outlined in Student Rule 7. While Student Rule 7, Section 7.3.2.1, indicates a medical confirmation note from the student's medical provider is preferred.

Galveston Campus Policies

Classroom Access and Inclusion Statement

Texas A&M University is committed to engaged student participation in all of its programs and courses and provides an accessible academic environment for all students. This means that our classrooms, our virtual spaces, our practices and our interactions are as inclusive as possible and we work to provide a welcoming instructional climate and equal learning opportunities for everyone. If you have an instructional need, please notify me as soon as possible.

The Aggie Core values of respect, excellence, leadership, loyalty, integrity and selfless service in addition to civility, and the ability to listen and to observe others are the foundation of a welcoming instructional climate. Active, thoughtful and respectful participation in all aspects of the course supports a more inclusive classroom environment as well as our mutual responsibilities to the campus community.

Statement on the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)

FERPA is a federal law designed to protect the privacy of educational records by limiting access to these records, to establish the right of students to inspect and review their educational records and to provide guidelines for the correction of inaccurate and misleading data through informal and formal hearings. Currently enrolled students wishing to withhold any or all directory information items may do so by going to howdy.tamu.edu and clicking on the "Directory Hold Information" link in the Student Records channel on the MyRecord tab. The complete FERPA Notice to Students and the student records policy is available on the Office of the Registrar webpage.

Items that can never be identified as public information are a student's social security number, citizenship, gender, grades, GPR or class schedule. All efforts will be made in this class to protect your privacy and to ensure confidential treatment of information associated with or generated by your participation in the class.

Directory items include name, UIN, local address, permanent address, email address, local telephone number, permanent telephone number, dates of attendance, program of study (college, major, campus), classification, previous institutions attended, degrees honors and awards received, participation in officially recognized activities and sports, medical residence location and medical residence specialization.

Statement on Course Evaluations

Texas A&M will use an online course evaluation tool through AEFIS (Assessment, Evaluation, Feedback & Intervention System). We highly encourage you to complete an evaluation for each course on your schedule. Student input is a critical component used to improve curriculum and teaching. Each faculty member values your input to improve his/her methodology. Your comments can also significantly impact the mix and membership of faculty. The course evaluations will be available through TAMU.AEFIS.NET and you will receive an email notification with a direct link to the system when the course evaluation becomes available.